

Mapping a Web Application with Burp Suite

Objective

The first step in web application penetration testing is to understand the application's structure. Burp Suite automatically builds a Site Map by capturing every HTTP request sent through the proxy. This allows the tester to identify all reachable pages, API endpoints, parameters, and application functionality before beginning security testing.

Workflow

1. Configure the browser to use Burp Suite as the proxy.
2. Enable interception if necessary.
3. Browse the application as a normal user.
4. Visit every accessible feature, page, and function.
5. Submit forms and interact with the application.
6. Observe how Burp automatically records every request.
7. Review the collected requests in **Target** → **Site Map**.
8. Use the Site Map to identify potential attack surfaces.

Why Site Map is Important

The Site Map provides a complete overview of the application's structure. Instead of guessing where vulnerabilities may exist, a penetration tester can systematically inspect every endpoint and parameter. This ensures that no important functionality is overlooked during testing.

Common Attack Surfaces

Examples of endpoints commonly tested include:

- Login
- Registration
- Password Reset
- Search
- Product Filters
- User Profile
- File Upload
- API Endpoints

- Administrative Functions